

November 7, 2025

Alex Afari, Jr.				
Kentucky				
Will Linebacker				
Height: 6020	Weight: 227	Year: 4SR	Jersey #: 3	Hometown: Cincinnati, OH
Games Reviewed: 2025 Georgia, Texas, Tennessee, South Carolina				
2025 Stats:				
Career Stats:				
Scouting Report by: Danny Nolan				

Critical Factors					
3-Down Ability		FBI/Instincts		Play Speed	
5		6		5	
Positional Factors					
3-Level Impact	QB Defense	Stoutness	Shed Ability	Navigate Trash	Tackling
4	5	3	4	5	6
Man Coverage	Zone Coverage	Range	Blitz	Toughness	ST Value
6	5	4	4	3	4

Strengths

- One-on-one tackling
- Filling the right running lane
- Versatility

Weaknesses

- Motor
- Initiating contact
- Stalemate blockers

Overall

Alex Afari, Jr. is a Will linebacker at the University of Kentucky. He is a three-down player who holds his own against the run and the pass, and he has experience in the Mike linebacker role as well. Afari is longer and leaner than the standard linebacker, as he spent his first two years as a Wildcat as a defensive back. Over the course of his college career, he has played in 45 games and started 29 of them, all at Kentucky. This season, he has started all 8 games. Afari was also a standout basketball player at Lakota West High School in Cincinnati, and his overall athleticism is evident. However, Afari's motor leaves much to be desired. He dogs it too often and rarely initiates contact.

Pass Game

Thanks to his experience in the secondary, Afari can hold his own against the pass. In man coverage, he does well to stick with tight ends and running backs. He is rarely asked to match up with a wide receiver but would likely be overmatched in such a scenario. He is slightly less effective in zone coverage, but that's not a result of any physical deficiency. His effort level is much higher in man, as he has a tendency to become lax and sag off receivers in his zone. His instincts are okay, but he will require more seasoning if he is ever to become a true quarterback of the defense. His range between the numbers is sufficient, although it is hampered by his habit of slowing to a jog before the play is finished. Afari is not a real weapon as a blitzer. He does not possess the strength nor finesse to shed blockers. He has plus acceleration, so he could be a fun chess piece for a defensive coordinator who can disguise blitzes to spring untouched rushers.

Run Game

Afari is a touch less impactful in the run game. When squared up with a lineman, he will not be a factor on the play. His hand use and anchor ability are not good enough. Afari is patient when filling gaps, which can be both a positive and a negative. On the bright side, he shows discipline and works within the system of the defense, keeping contain or staying home on a read option. However, this patience also means he doesn't get downhill and initiate contact at the line of scrimmage. He often lets the ball carrier come to him instead of being on the attack, resulting in allowing additional yards. When he gets to the ball, Afari has no problem tackling, an impressive tool for a former DB. On longer rushing plays, rushers don't need to worry about being tracked down by Afari. He only rallies to the ball when he is sure he'll make an impact on the play. That needs to change if he is to have an impact at the professional level.

Last Word

In the NFL, Afari projects best as a Will linebacker asked to drop into coverage often. Although he has functioned as the Mike at Kentucky, he currently isn't strong enough to hang there in the pros. His coverage skills could make him an asset on third down, but he shouldn't be expected to perform like a true defensive back. Afari has seen limited usage on special teams as a Wildcat, but he has the

physical composition to earn playing time as a core player. His toughness holds him back in this area. Afari started the 2025 season strong against weaker competition but has struggled in SEC play.

One-Liner: Afari has a frame and instincts that should interest NFL teams, but he needs to add strength and play with more violence to be a difference-maker at the next level.

Grade: 5.7 - Ceiling: 5.9 (15%) Floor: 5.4 (25%) Round: UDFA